

» AFTER

Unpopular policies and corrupt practices aided recruitment to the Viet Cong.

RECRUITING GROUNDS

The **Strategic Hamlets Program** forced people living in rural areas prone to Viet Cong infiltration to move to specially fortified villages. This alienated the rural population, driving them into the arms of the Viet Cong.

SECRET NETWORK

The spread of the Viet Cong through South Vietnam, and infiltration of the country by the NVA, was facilitated by the expansion of the **Ho Chi Minh Trail**.